

No Fear Public Speaking by Practicing

How to Practice Public Speaking

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Synopsis

Glossophobia, the fear of public speaking, usually ranks pretty high on surveys of 'what people fear'. And for good reason. We've all attended conferences where the keynote speakers were seriously injured after being hit by a torrent of rolled up feedback forms, or speakers were left bleeding from a rain of plastic name badges thrown Shuriken-like by the Ninja trained attendees.

Synopsis

You can learn to avoid these outcomes, and when you do, you gain a skill that will win you recognition, improve your job prospects and allow you to travel the world talking to fellow testers.

We Learn Public Speaking by Speaking in Public

We do it better when we gain experience. We have to gain experience by doing.

Which means...

At some point we are speaking in public without experience.

Learn from others: books, workshops (like this), **your experience (of others).**

On Fear

- Fear is Natural?
 - Fight or Flight Explanations
- Is it fear?
 - Adrenalin != Fear
 - Physiology
 - Excitement

Solutions

- Pretalk exercises
- Breathing
- Talk Slower
- Practice
- Contingencies

Prep - Practice and Contingency Planning

- Practice reduces uncertainty and develops confidence
- Contingency Planning mitigates risk

Prep - Practice

- out loud
- in your head

Prep - Practice Different Styles

Adopt different presentation styles

- as funny as possible
- as outlandish as possible
- no jokes
- as many jokes and quips as you can
- Super excited
- slow and steady
- present from deck, without the deck
- with different timings

Prep - Practice

- Record your practice sessions
- Video/Audio
- Listen back for 'nuggets'
 - add to speaker notes or on slides
- Later practices - transcribe ([rev.com](https://www.rev.com), [trint.com](https://www.trint.com))
 - can amend to create a paper
- for timing
- do you need prompts on the slides?

Prep - Practice to convince yourself that:

- you can do this;
- you know the material;
- you can work without slides;
- you know the experiences you are building on;
- you can do this.

Practice so that you *Know* what you are talking about and that you can talk about it.

Speaking in Public

Speaking in public is a skill, that you can develop if you care enough about the message that you want to deliver. It is simply practice, and you can do that.

END

Learn to "Be Evil"

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BIO

Alan is a test consultant who enjoys testing at a technical level using techniques from psychotherapy and computer science. In his spare time Alan is currently programming a [multi-user text adventure game](#) and some [buggy JavaScript games](#) in the style of the Cascade Cassette 50. Alan is the author of the books "[Dear Evil Tester](#)", "[Java For Testers](#)" and "[Automating and Testing a REST API](#)". Alan's main website is compendiumdev.co.uk and he blogs at blog.eviltester.com